JAWERIA QAISER
Curriculum Vitae
Department of Psychology
University of Toronto, Mississauga
jaweria.qaiser@mail.utoronto.ca

EDUCATION

2021 – Present Ph.D., Social/Personality Psychology
University of Toronto (UofT)

2017 – 2021 H.B.Sc., Psychology (Neurobiology) specialist & Biology minor
University of Toronto Mississauga (UTM)
Graduated with distinction.

SCHOLARSHIPS & AWARDS

2025 UofT Graduate Department of Psychology Conference Travel Award ($500)
2025 SSHRC Storytellers Challenge Winner ($4,000)
2025 UofT Critical Digital Humanities Initiative Travel Honorarium ($750)
2025 UofT Graduate Department of Psychology Conference Travel Award ($500)
2024 SSHRC Canada Graduate Scholarship Doctoral Award ($80,000)
2024 UofT SGS Conference Grant ($380)
2024 UofT Institute of Medical Science Art Revealing Science Symposium Winner ($100)
2023 Ontario Graduate Award Scholarship (OGS; $15,000)
2022 Society for Personality & Social Psychology Vignette Competition Winner ($285)
2022 SSHRC Canada Graduate Scholarship Master's Level (CGS-M; $17,500)
2021 UTM 3-Minute Thesis Social Sciences Division Winner ($300)
2021 UTM Honour's Thesis Completion Award
2021 UTM Experiential Education Bursary ($500)
2021 UofT Autonomy Funds ($168)
2017 UTM Entrance Scholarship Award ($1,000)

TEACHING/ MENTORING EXPERIENCE

2025-2026 **Mentor,** Research Opportunity Program student (stress as a construct of empathy)
University of Toronto
- Mentee received University of Toronto Undergraduate Research Award under my supervision, 2026.

2025-2026 **Mentor,** Research Opportunity Program student (empathising with group emotions)
University of Toronto

2025 **Lecturer** on Psychophysiology, Summer Psychology Research Initiative
University of Toronto

2025 **Mentor,** Independent Research Project student (stress as a construct of empathy)
University of Toronto

2025 **Mentor,** Independent Research Project student (empathising with group emotions)
University of Toronto

2024 – 2025 **Mentor,** Independent Research Project student (compassion fatigue)
University of Toronto
- Mentee contributed to and co-authored a peer-reviewed publication: "Compassion Persists: The Effects of Repeated Exposure to Suffering on Compassion," 2026.

2024 **Lecturer** on Psychophysiology, Summer Psychology Research Initiative
University of Toronto

2024 **Guest Lecture** on Psychophysiology, Psychology of Emotions (PSY331)
University of Toronto

2024 **Mentor**, Research Opportunity Program application writing
University of Toronto

2023 **Lecturer** on Psychophysiology, Summer Psychology Research Initiative
University of Toronto

2022 – 2023 **Honour's Thesis Mentor**, Physiological underpinnings of self-compassion
University of Toronto

TEACHING ASSISTANTSHIPS

2025 **Graduate Teaching Assistant**
University of Toronto
- Perception Laboratory (PSY389) Fall 2025
- Special Topics Seminar in Social Psychology (PSY420) Fall 2025

2023 – 2024 **Graduate Teaching Assistant**
University of Toronto
- Introduction to Social Psychology (PSY220) Fall 2023
- Biopsychology of Sex (PSY354) Fall 2023
- Psychology of Emotions (PSY331) Winter 2024

2021 – 2022 **Graduate Teaching Assistant**
University of Toronto
- Introduction to Social Psychology (PSY220) Fall 2021; Winter 2022
- Introduction to Developmental Psychology (PSY210) Winter 2022
- Psychology of Emotions (PSY331) Summer 2022

2018 – 2019 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant**
University of Toronto
- Introduction to Psychology (PSY100) Computer Lab Assistant

TEACHING CERTIFICATIONS & COURSES

2022 – 2025 **Advanced University Teaching Preparation Certificate**
University of Toronto

2022 **PSY3100: The Science of Learning**
University of Toronto

2025 – Present **Accessible, Inclusive, and Anti-Oppressive Pedagogies Certificate**
University of Toronto

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2021 – Present **Graduate Researcher**
University of Toronto
Supervisor: Dr. Jennifer Stellar

2023 – 2024 **Graduate Researcher**, Outside Project
University of Toronto
Supervisors: Dr. Anna Kosovicheva & Dr. Benjamin Wolfe

2020 – 2021 **Undergraduate Researcher,** Honour's Thesis student
University of Toronto
Supervisor: Dr. Jennifer Stellar

2020 – 2021 **Undergraduate Researcher**, Independent Research Project

	University of Toronto Supervisor: Dr. Jennifer Stellar
2019	**Undergraduate Research Assistant**, Research Opportunity Program *University of Toronto* Supervisor: Dr. Sanja Hinic-Frlog
2018 – 2019	**Undergraduate Research Assistant**, Work-Study *University of Toronto* Supervisor: Dr. Jeff Graham
2018 – 2021	**Undergraduate Research Assistant** *University of Toronto* Supervisor: Dr. Jennifer Stellar

EMPLOYMENT

2017 – 2019	Director, Data Science Education *STEM Fellowship* Project: Organised national and international data science challenges for high school and undergraduate students engaging 400+ students. Delivered data science workshops. Negotiated and secured $130,000+ in funding support.

MANUSCRIPTS

Qaiser, J., Draga, M., Pham, L., Leonhardt, N., & Stellar, J. E. (*invited revision*). Compassion Persists: The Effects of Repeated Exposure to Suffering on Compassion. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*.

Qaiser, J., Leonhardt, N.D., Le, B.M., Gordon, A. M., Impett, E. A., & Stellar, J. E. (2023a). Shared Hearts and Minds: Physiological Synchrony During Empathy. *Affective Science*, 4, 711–721.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

Qaiser, J., Jona, D., & Stellar, J. (in preparation). When empathy hurts and helps: Exploring the functional role of stress in empathic processes.

Ma, R., **Qaiser, J.**, Schreiber, A. M., Le, B. M., Gordon, A. M., Impett, E. A., Stellar, J. E., & Lindquist, K. A. (in preparation). Physiological co-regulation during husbands' distress disclosure predicts husbands' felt closeness and both partners' relationship satisfaction 14 days later.

BOOK CHAPTERS

Qaiser, J. & Stellar, J. E. (*forthcoming*). Personality and Emotion Contagion. In *Research Handbook on Personality and Emotion.*

PUBLISHED CONFERENCE ABSTRACTS

Qaiser, J., Leonhardt, N., Le, B. M., Gordon, A. M., & Stellar, J. E. (2023b). Empathy and Physiological Synchrony. In Abstracts from the 2022 Annual Meeting of the Society for Affective Science_ Experience of Emotion. *Affective Science*, *4*, 199-209.

Qaiser, J. & Noukhovitch, S. (2019a). 2019 Undergraduate Big Data Challenge: Big Data of Recreational Drugs. *STEM Fellowship Journal*. *5*(1): 29-39.

Qaiser, J. & Noukhovitch, S. (2018). Abstracts from the High School Big Data Challenge 2017-2018: Think Global, Act Local with Big Data. *STEM Fellowship Journal*. *4*(1): 48-55.

NON-REFEREED CONTRIBUTIONS

Caring Without Collapse: Rethinking Compassion Fatigue to Sustain Service Excellence in Canada's Federal Public Service (2026a, April). *Canada School of Public Service*. Finalist, National Student Paper Writing Competition.

Students Connect Social Science with Advocacy in 100 Words or Less (2023c, January). *Society for Personality and Social Psychology News.* **Winner, Vignette writing competition.**

CREATIVE CONTRIBUTIONS

Qaiser, J. (2025a, January). *Reading the room: Empathy for groups* [video]. YouTube. https://youtu.be/OdLvUV-6Tj0?si=u2EGF-2f9YV2mupz. Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council Storytellers Challenge. **Winner, SSHRC Storytellers Challenge.**

Qaiser, J. (2024a, February). *Shared Hearts and Minds: The Interpersonal Nature of Empathy*. [Canvas Painting, Presentation,]. Art Revealing Science Symposium, Institute of Medical Science, University of Toronto. **Winner in non-digital category.**

Qaiser, J. (2022a, January). *Colourful Parade* [Sculpture]. 'Situational Inverse: Overturning Traditions,' Greenwood, University of Toronto Mississauga.

OPEN SCIENCE CONTRIBUTIONS

Contributor, Second Edition of BIO202 Open Access Textbook (University of Toronto, 2020)

PRESENTATIONS

Qaiser, J., Draga, M., Pham, L., Leonhardt, N., & Stellar, J. E. (2026b, June). *Compassion Persists: The Effects of Repeated Exposure to Suffering on Compassion* [Symposium talk]. European Association of Social Psychology General Meeting, Strasbourg, France. Presented by L. Pham.

Qaiser, J. (2026c, June). *When Compassion Backfires: Communicating Emotionally Intense Science*. Science Writers and Communicators of Canada 2026 Conference, Montreal, QC, Canada [Talk].

Qaiser, J. (2026d, May). *Caring Without Collapse: Rethinking Compassion Fatigue to Sustain Service Excellence in Canada's Federal Public Service*. Canada School of Public Service's National Student Paper Competition 2026 [Talk, virtual].

Qaiser, J. (2026e, April). *Compassion Persists: The Effects of Repeated Exposure to Suffering on Compassion* [Talk]. University of Toronto Graduate, Researcher, and Trainee Talk Series.

Qaiser, J., & Stellar, J. (2025b, June). *Reading the room: Empathic accuracy for group emotions* [Talk]. 2025 Science Writers and Communicators of Canada Conference, Fredericton, NB, Canada. **Winner, SSHRC Storytellers Challenge.**

Qaiser, J., Wolfe, B., Kosovicheva, A, & Stellar, J. (2025c, May). *Reading the room: Empathic accuracy for group emotions* [Talk]. 2025 Interdisciplinary Conference in Psychology, Ottawa, ON, Canada.

Ma, R., **Qaiser, J.**, Schreiber, A. M., Le, B. M., Gordon, A. M., Impett, E. A., Stellar, J. E., & Lindquist, K. A. (2025d, March). *Physiological co-regulation during husbands' distress disclosure predicts husbands' felt closeness and both partners' relationship satisfaction 14 days later*. Flash talk presented at the 2025 Society for Affective Science (SAS) Annual Conference, Portland, OR.

Qaiser, J., Wolfe, B., Kosovicheva, A, & Stellar, J. (2025e, February). *Reading the room: Empathy for groups* [Poster]. Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Convention, Denver, CO, United States.

Qaiser, J., Leonhardt, N.D., Le, B.M., Gordon, A. M., Impett, E. A., & Stellar, J. E. (2024b, April). *Shared Hearts and Minds: Physiological Synchrony During Empathy* [Poster]. York University's Social Personality Area (YUTSPA) Conference, York, Canada.

Qaiser, J., Leonhardt, N.D., Le, B.M., Gordon, A. M., Impett, E. A., & Stellar, J. E. (2024c, April). *Shared Hearts and Minds: Physiological Synchrony During Empathy* [Poster]. Social Affective Neuroscience Society, Toronto, Canada.

Qaiser, J. & Stellar, J. E. (2024d, February). *Having tough conversations: The psychological experience of moral discussions with those who hold opposing views*. [Talk]. University of Toronto 3-Minute Thesis competition.

Qaiser, J. & Stellar, J. E. (2024e, February). *Caring might not cost you: Effects of repeated exposure to suffering on compassion*. [Poster]. Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Convention, San Diego, CA, United States.

Qaiser, J. & Stellar, J. (2024f, October). *Eyes: The windows to reading other's emotions?* [Talk]. University of Toronto Brown Bag Series.

Qaiser, J. & Stellar, J. (2023e, March). *Understanding Compassion Fatigue*. [Talk]. University of Toronto Social Personality Research Group.

Qaiser, J. & Stellar, J. (2023f, March). *Understanding Compassion Fatigue*. [Talk]. University of Toronto Brown Bag Series.

Qaiser, J. & Stellar, J. E. (2023g, March). *Reading the Room*. [Talk, virtual]. University of Toronto 3-Minute Thesis competition. **Semi-finalist.**

Qaiser, J. & Stellar, J. E. (2023h, February). *Understanding Compassion Fatigue*. [Poster]. Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Convention, Atlanta, GA, United States.

Qaiser, J., Leonhardt, N., Le, B. M., Gordon, A. M., & Stellar, J. E. (2022b, April). *Empathy and Physiological Synchrony*. [Poster, virtual]. Society for Affective Science Annual Convention. **Selected as a top abstract, published.**

Qaiser, J. & Stellar, J. E. (2022c, March). *Understanding Compassion Fatigue*. [Talk, virtual]. University of Toronto 3-Minute Thesis competition. **Finalist scoring in top 10.**

Qaiser, J. (2022d, March). *UTM Psychology Inclusion, Diversity, Equity, and Access Panel*. [Panel of professors, postdoctoral fellows, graduate students, and alumni from minority groups help an open discussion with under-represented minority undergraduate students]. University of Toronto Mississauga.

Qaiser, J., Leonhardt, N., Le, B. M., Gordon, A. M., & Stellar, J. E. (2022e, February). *Empathy and Physiological Synchrony*. [Poster, virtual]. Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Convention.

Qaiser, J. & Stellar, J. (2022f, February). *Understanding Compassion Fatigue*. [Virtual Presentation]. University of Toronto Brown Bag Series.

Qaiser, J. & Stellar, J. E. (2021a, December). *Physiological Sharing as a Component of Empathy: How suffering under the skin extends to conscious suffering*. [Talk, virtual]. University of Toronto Mississauga 3-Minute Thesis competition. **Winner in Social Sciences division.**

Qaiser, J. & Stellar, J. E. (2021b, May). *Physiological sharing during dyadic experiences of compassion*. [Poster, virtual]. Annual Ontario Psychology Undergraduate Thesis Conference.

Qaiser, J. & Stellar, J. E. (2021c, April). *Physiological sharing during dyadic experiences of compassion*. [Poster, virtual]. University of Toronto (Mississauga Undergraduate Thesis Day.

Qaiser, J. & Stellar, J. E. (2021d, April). *Physiological sharing during dyadic experiences of compassion*. [Poster, virtual]. Society for Affective Science Annual Convention.

Qaiser, J. & Stellar, J. E. (2021e, February). *Physiological influence between romantic partners during a compassion induction*. [Poster, virtual]. Emotions Preconference, Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Convention.

Qaiser, J. & Stellar, J. E. (2020a, April). *Methodology to Analyse Nested Physiology Data*. [Poster; cancelled due to COVID-19]. Thesis Day, University of Toronto Mississauga.

Qaiser, J. (2020b, March). *Psychology Student Panel*. [Successful upper-year undergraduate students share their perspectives and experience with students interested in applying to the University of Toronto's Psychology Program]. University of Toronto Mississauga.

Qaiser, J., Thomas, R., Hanley, J., Laughton, S., & Hinić-Frlog, S. (2019b, August). *Student Perspective on Open Textbook Use*. [Poster]. Smarti Gras Biology Day, University of Toronto Mississauga.

REVIEWER

2026	**Reviewer,** Manuscript *Personality Science*
2025	**Reviewer** (poster submissions), Annual Convention 2025 *Society for Personality and Social Psychology*
2024	**Reviewer,** Manuscript *Cognitive Processing*
2023	**Reviewer** (poster submissions), Annual Convention 2024 *Society for Personality and Social Psychology*

VOLUNTEER ACTIVITIES

2026	**Judge**, Undergraduate Research Day *University of Toronto Mississauga*
2024	**Judge**, Summer Psychology Research Initiative *University of Toronto*
2024	**Judge**, Undergraduate Research Day *University of Toronto Mississauga*
2024	**Speaker**, Undergraduate Research Student Association Networking Event *University of Toronto Mississauga*
2022	**Speaker** (alumni), Student Programming Planning Interactive Exhibition *University of Toronto Mississauga*
2022	**Panellist**, Panel discussion for Underrepresented Minority Groups *University of Toronto Mississauga*
2022	**Judge**, Ethics Debate Bowl *Ontario High School Ethics Bowl*
2021 – 2022	**Program Developer**, Program Committee for Inaugural Symposium *Psychology Graduate Student Association, University of Toronto*
2020 – 2021	**Workshop Developer & Facilitator**, Training for Persons with Disabilities *Community Living Mississauga*
2020	**Panellist**, Panel of successful upper-year Psychology students *University of Toronto Mississauga*
2019	**Workshop Facilitator**, Introduction to Coding *Metamorphosis Girls STEM Conference 2019*
2017	**Associate Team Lead**, Scholarly Writing Challenge *STEM Fellowship*
2016 – 2019	**Workshop Developer**, Data Science Education *STEM Fellowship*